Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Declan and Delia are planning a Saturday date.

Declan: So, are we still on for Saturday?

Delia: **I hope so**. Unless my sister needs a babysitter again.

Declan: **Let's hope not**. Fancy the food market by the river?

Delia: **I'd love to**. I haven't been since it reopened.

Declan: **Neither have I**. And maybe that comedy night afterwards?

Delia: Honestly, **I'd rather not**. Stand-up's not really my thing.

Declan: Fair enough. What about that new Korean place, then? I've been dying to try it.

Delia: **So have I**! Should we book, though? It's always packed.

Declan: Already done. Eight o'clock. I had a feeling you'd say yes.

Delia: Smooth. You know me way too well.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. Neither have I.

strong: "Neither", "I"
weak: "have"

Câu đồng tình rất ngắn: nhấn "Neither" và "I", "have" đọc nhẹ. Người Anh hay đọc "neither" là /ˈnaɪðə/, người Mỹ hay đọc /ˈniːðɚ/.

2. Honestly, I'd rather not.

change: "Honestly" (h câm)
strong: "rather"

"Honestly" đọc /ˈɑːnəstli/, nói nhanh mất luôn t: "á-nơs-li". Đây là lời từ chối nên giọng hạ dần, mềm mỏng.

3. I had a feeling you'd say yes.

linking: "had‿a‿feeling"
change: "you'd say" (d gần như mất)
strong: "feeling", "yes"

"had a" nối thành "ha-đơ". Nói nhanh, d của "you'd" gần như mất trước "say". Giọng hơi tự đắc, nhấn mạnh "yes".

• Câu tỉnh lược ngắn nhấn vào từ mang thông tin mới: So have I, Neither have I → nhấn "I".
• Trợ động từ ở giữa đọc nhẹ, nối liền: so have I → "sô-hơ-vai".
• "Honestly", "honest", "hour" đều có h câm.
• Lời từ chối (I'd rather not) cần giọng mềm, hạ dần; nói cụt lủn nghe rất phũ.

Role Play track 27

A: So, are we still on for Saturday?

B: _____. Unless my sister needs a babysitter again.

A: Let's hope not. Fancy the food market by the river?

B: _____. I haven't been since it reopened.

A: Neither have I. And maybe that comedy night afterwards?

B: Honestly, _____. Stand-up's not really my thing.

A: Fair enough. What about that new Korean place, then? I've been dying to try it.

B: So have I! Should we book, though? It's always packed.

A: Already done. Eight o'clock. I had a feeling you'd say yes.

B: Smooth. You know me way too well.

Study Notes

So, are we still on for Saturday?
Thứ Bảy mình vẫn đi như đã hẹn chứ?
"be on" nghĩa là kế hoạch vẫn diễn ra, không bị huỷ.
Cách nói tương đương: Is Saturday still happening?

Stand-up's not really my thing.
Mình không mê hài độc thoại lắm.
"… is not my thing" là cách nói nhẹ nhàng rằng mình không thích việc gì.
Cách nói tương đương: I'm not really into stand-up.

Grammar Focus

Thay thế bằng so / not: I hope so, I think so, I'm afraid not

Dùng so (khẳng định) hoặc not (phủ định) sau hope, think, guess, be afraid để khỏi nhắc lại cả câu. Không nói "I hope it".

Will it rain tomorrow? – **I hope not**.
Is Tom coming tonight? – **I think so**.
Did you get the tickets? – **I'm afraid not**.

Tỉnh lược: I'd love to / So do I / Neither have I

Bỏ phần đã nhắc, chỉ giữ "to" hoặc trợ động từ. Đồng tình: So + trợ động từ + I (khẳng định), Neither + trợ động từ + I (phủ định).

Want to come along? – **I'd love to**.
I love this song. – **So do I**.
I've never tried sushi. – **Neither have I**.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. **I hope so**. Unless my sister needs a babysitter again.
   a. I think so
   b. I believe so
   c. We should be

2. **I'd love to**. I haven't been since it reopened.
   a. I've been meaning to
   b. Yes, let's
   c. Absolutely

3. Honestly, **I'd rather not**.
   a. I'd prefer not to
   b. I think I'll pass
   c. I'm not really up for it